Middle Stage Quick Reference

01 Contribute substance

- Share relevant research and insights frequently.
- Verbally cite publication and date; explain why evidence matters.
- Use anecdotes to illustrate, not replace, evidence.
- Avoid repetition and unrelated detours.

02 Support the group

- Take notes on ideas, evidence, and their contributors; look up regularly.
- Help track the round and agreed agenda periods.
- Invite perspectives without repeatedly singling people out.
- Redirect respectfully toward the WHAT and HOW of the task.

03 Communicate professionally

- Listen actively; avoid visible frustration and distracting habits.
- Address fellow discussants, not the judge.
- Use concise language suited to your assigned role.
- Speak clearly and maintain volume through sentence endings.

04 Manage speaking conflicts

- Continue assertively only with care; it risks dominance.
- Request first turn and honor your promise to yield.
- Yield and request the next turn when appropriate.
- Explain a timely, direct connection when requesting a turn.
- If interrupted, politely finish and give the promised speaker a turn.

05 Your goal

- **Contribute evidence. Build on others. Keep the group moving toward a solution.**